

Psalms 31

Into Thy Hand

Into thine hand I commit my spirit
KJV · Standalone study handout

1 · THE WORD (KJV)

- 1 *In thee, O LORD, do I put my trust; let me never be ashamed: deliver me in thy righteousness.*
- 2 *Bow down thine ear to me; deliver me speedily: be thou my strong rock, for an house of defence to save me.*
- 3 *For thou art my rock and my fortress; therefore for thy name's sake lead me, and guide me.*
- 4 *Pull me out of the net that they have laid privily for me: for thou art my strength.*
- 5 *Into thine hand I commit my spirit: thou hast redeemed me, O LORD God of truth.*
- 6 *I have hated them that regard lying vanities: but I trust in the LORD.*
- 7 *I will be glad and rejoice in thy mercy: for thou hast considered my trouble; thou hast known my soul in adversities;*
- 8 *And hast not shut me up into the hand of the enemy: thou hast set my feet in a large room.*
- 9 *Have mercy upon me, O LORD, for I am in trouble: mine eye is consumed with grief, yea, my soul and my belly.*
- 10 *For my life is spent with grief, and my years with sighing: my strength faileth because of mine iniquity, and my bones are consumed.*
- 11 *I was a reproach among all mine enemies, but especially among my neighbours, and a fear to mine acquaintance: they that did see me without fled from me.*
- 12 *I am forgotten as a dead man out of mind: I am like a broken vessel.*
- 13 *For I have heard the slander of many: fear was on every side: while they took counsel together against me, they devised to take away my life.*
- 14 *But I trusted in thee, O LORD: I said, Thou art my God.*
- 15 *My times are in thy hand: deliver me from the hand of mine enemies, and from them that persecute me.*
- 16 *Make thy face to shine upon thy servant: save me for thy mercies' sake.*
- 17 *Let me not be ashamed, O LORD; for I have called upon thee: let the wicked be ashamed, and let them be silent in the grave.*
- 18 *Let the lying lips be put to silence; which speak grievous things proudly and contemptuously against the righteous.*
- 19 *Oh how great is thy goodness, which thou hast laid up for them that fear thee; which thou hast wrought for them that trust in thee before the sons of men!*
- 20 *Thou shalt hide them in the secret of thy presence from the pride of man: thou shalt keep them secretly in a pavilion from the strife of tongues.*
- 21 *Blessed be the LORD: for he hath shewed me his marvellous kindness in a strong city.*
- 22 *For I said in my haste, I am cut off from before thine eyes: nevertheless thou heardest the voice of my supplications when I cried unto thee.*
- 23 *O love the LORD, all ye his saints: for the LORD preserveth the faithful, and plentifully rewardeth the proud doer.*
- 24 *Be of good courage, and he shall strengthen your heart, all ye that hope in the LORD.*

2 · CONTEXT

Psalms 31 is a lament of David under real pressure—slander, plots, and a body worn down by grief—that keeps circling back to trust in the Lord as rock and fortress. Its central line, “Into thine hand I commit my spirit” (v. 5), became Jesus’ own dying prayer (Luke 23:46) and Stephen’s under stoning (Acts 7:59), showing how deeply the church has leaned on this psalm in extremity. Henry traces its rhythm as complaint answered by renewed resolve: David names his affliction honestly, then talks himself back into confidence in God’s hand and God’s “times.” It reads as a template for suffering saints who anchor identity in God’s care rather than in their circumstances or critics.

3 · VERSE-BY-VERSE COMMENTARY

The notes below cover the whole chapter in one place—read with the KJV text above.

Verse 1-5

David pleads for a refuge that will not let him be ashamed—“be thou my strong rock, for an house of defence.” He commits his very spirit into God’s hand, resting on the character of “thou God of truth” rather than on any change in his situation.

Verse 6-8

He renounces trust in lying vanities (idols and false securities) and rests in the Lord’s mercy. God has considered his trouble, known his soul in adversity, and “set my feet in a large room”—room to move rather than a cornered trap.

Verse 9-13

The distress is total: eye, soul, and body consumed with grief; years spent in sighing; strength failing; reproach among neighbors and fear to acquaintances, as if he were already forgotten like a dead man. Whispering and plotting surround him with fear on every side.

Verse 14-18

The turning point: “But I trusted in thee, O Lord: I said, Thou art my God. My times are in thy hand.” He asks for deliverance, for God’s face to shine, and that the wicked’s lying lips be silenced rather than his own good name.

Verse 19-22

Goodness is “laid up” for those who fear the Lord and is publicly known. He is hidden in God’s presence from the strife of tongues and blesses the Lord for marvellous kindness shown “in a strong city.” He admits his own hasty despair—“I said... I am cut off”—yet confesses God heard him anyway.

Verse 23-24

A closing charge to all the saints: love the Lord, for He preserves the faithful and repays the proud. Be of good courage, and He shall strengthen your heart, all ye that hope in the Lord.

4 · MEANING & APPLICATION

Meaning.

Psalm 31 teaches that real affliction—grief, slander, isolation—does not disqualify trust; it is the very setting where trust is exercised. Entrusting one’s spirit, reputation, and “times” into God’s hand does not deny the pain but refuses to let the pain have the final word. God’s goodness is real even when hidden, and He hears cries that feel, in the moment, like despair.

Application for life today.

Use verse 5 as a prayer at bedtime or in genuine crisis—it has carried Christ Himself and countless believers since. When reputation is under attack, notice how David asks God to silence lying lips rather than mounting his own defense first. When you catch yourself, like David in verse 22, saying something is hopeless, keep praying anyway; God heard him even in that moment of despair.

5 · REFLECT & RESPOND

Write your answers in the space below. There are no “right length” answers—honesty before God is the aim.

- 1.** What would it look like this week to “commit” a specific fear, relationship, or outcome into God’s hand rather than gripping it yourself?
- 2.** Where do you feel the isolation of verses 9–13—and how does David’s honesty give you permission to name that to God?
- 3.** How does knowing “my times are in thy hand” (v. 15) change how you face an uncertain situation right now?

Name: _____ Date: _____ Group / Church: _____

Sources: King James Version (public domain); Matthew Henry, *Commentary on the Whole Bible* (themes summarized); Expository themes consistent with MacArthur Study Bible tradition (paraphrased, not quoted). Scripture: King James Version (public domain).